

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
 ♥ A 6 4 3
 ♦ 8 5 4 3
 ♣ A K J

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ 5 3

♥ K Q J 10

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

North

1♠

*East**South*

All Pass

1♠ by North

Lead: ♦Q

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
♥ A K J 9
♦ J 9 8
♣ 8 7 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6



♠ 5 3
♥ Q 6 4 3
♦ 10 5 3 2
♣ A 10 9

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s.
But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened
she would make a Limit Raise to 3♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs
to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1♠
Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise
to 2♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids
4♠.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
 ♥ Q 9 6 4
 ♦ J 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4



♠ 5 3

♥ A K J 3

♦ Q 10 3 2

♣ A 9 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

This time NORTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when WEST opens 1♥ NORTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 13 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would insist on game. But NORTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So SOUTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and NORTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

West

1♥

North

1♠

East

Pass

South

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Lead: ♥A

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 4 2
 ♥ Q 9 8 2
 ♦ 9 6 4 2
 ♣ J 10

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ Q J

♥ A K J 6 3

♦ J 10 5

♣ 9 4 3

♠ A 10 5 3

♥ 10 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ 4

North

Dbl

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♠